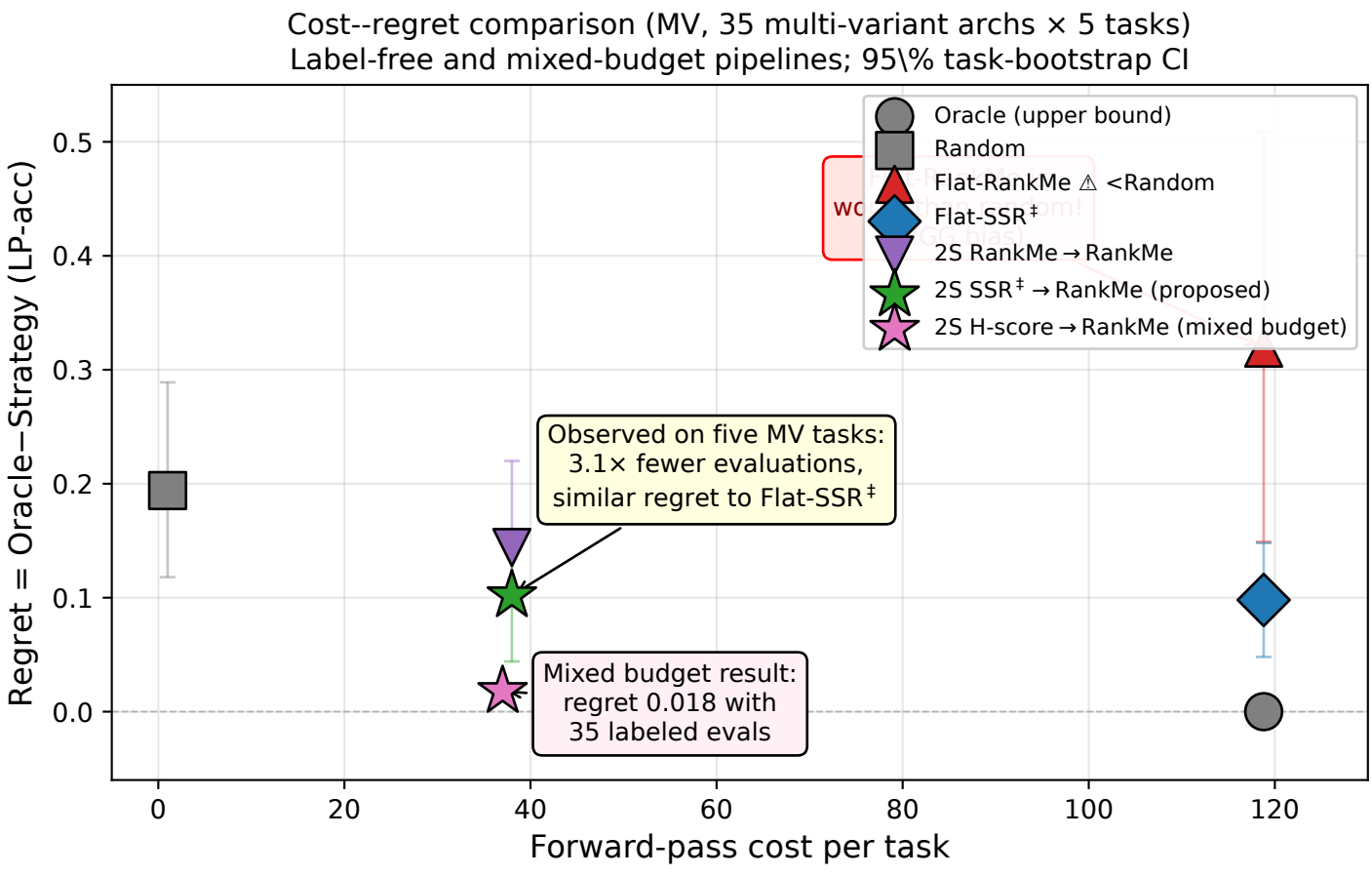
Cost--regret comparison (MV, 35 multi-variant archs × 5 tasks)
Label-free and mixed-budget pipelines; 95\% task-bootstrap CI
Oracle (upper bound)
Random
Flat-RankMe ⚠ <Random
Flat-SSR‡
2S RankMe → RankMe
2S SSR‡ → RankMe (proposed)
2S H-score → RankMe (mixed budget)
Observed on five MV tasks:
3.1× fewer evaluations,
similar regret to Flat-SSR‡
Mixed budget result:
regret 0.018 with
35 labeled evals
Regret = Oracle−Strategy (LP-acc)
0.0
0.1
0.2
0.3
0.4
0.5
0
20
40
60
80
100
120
Forward-pass cost per task